FRAMEWORK FOR APPOINTMENT OF PROFESSOR EMERITUS IN THE HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS (HEIs)

Higher Education Commission
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Purpose and Objective:

The purpose and objective of appointing a Professor Emeritus is to recognize and honor the distinguished academic service and contributions of the Professor beyond superannuation. This title acknowledges their professional achievements, dedication, and impact on their field, while also encouraging their continued involvement with the institution. By bestowing this title, the institution benefits from the Emeritus Professor's ongoing engagement in research, mentorship, and intellectual activities, thereby enhancing its reputation and fostering a rich academic environment.

The universities may appoint Professor Emeritus on prescribed guidelines of the Higher Education Commission (HEC) through their statutory process.

1. Provision of Titles:

1.1. The appointment of Professor Emeritus is to be decided by the Syndicate/Appointing Authority of the respective university.

1.2. The number of Professors Emeritus would vary from university to university depending on its size and demand, but total number should not exceed 10% of the total working strength of the regular working Professors in a faculty.

2. Eligibility Criteria:

2.1. University Syndicate/Appointing Authority may confer status of an Emeritus Professorship to a Professor retired or retired with the tenured status in recognition of his/her scholarship and service to university education who has served university or a constituent institute or a Centre of Excellence of the University for a minimum period of **10 years as Professor**. However, those who hold the title of Distinguished National Professor (DNP) or Meritorious Professor qualify to be considered even if the experience as Professor is less than 10 years.

OR

2.2. A Professor who has completed at least one tenure as a Vice-Chancellor in the public sector university shall be conferred the status of Professor Emeritus (PE) after attaining the age of superannuation. He/she can apply for joining as Professor Emeritus at the parent university or at a university other than the parent university, preferably in a newly developed university.

In cases of the Vice Chancellors joining as PE at newly developed universities, other than the parent universities, HEC may invite three preferences from newly developed universities and/or the interested Vice Chancellors may themselves offer their services as Professor Emeritus for other such universities where their services are more valued. In that case, NoC from parent university and the consent from host university would be required. Young universities, where senior faculty is not yet available for PE, are

encouraged to advertise positions of PE, through approval of its Syndicate/Appointing Authority.

3. Procedure:

3.1. All such cases be decided by the concerned university through Syndicate/Appointing Authority in light of the HEC's guidelines.

3.2. Those who are desirous to join as Professor Emeritus in the concerned university may submit or get nominated by the concerned Chair or Dean in writing, preferably 06 months before the age of superannuation.

4. Terms and Conditions:

4.1. Whereas the conferment of PE status will be for life time, the financial benefits will be given for a maximum period of 10 years or up to the age of 70 years, whichever is earlier.

The PE is expected to contribute to the academic life of the university to a great extent in consonance with the status and caliber of the title and PE shall carry no formal statutory administrative positions in a university, where other senior faculty is/are available for such positions. However, at young universities, where senior faculty is not available to take up administrative positions, PE may be asked to take up administrative positions.

4.2. Professor Emeritus up to the age of 65 years, would be eligible to apply for HEC research funding, but he/she would be required to include at least one Co-PI from the host Institution.

4.3. The Professor Emeritus, at least for the period during which he/she enjoys financial benefits from the University, will have the following responsibilities:

- 4.3.1. Mandatory presence on campus at least for three working days a week.
- 4.3.2. Provide guidance or continue research with faculty and/or students.
- 4.3.3. Graduate student's supervision.
- 4.3.4. Seminars and/or writing of textbooks in the field of his/her specialization.
- 4.3.5. Any other assignment by the Vice Chancellor, including statutory academic administrative positions temporarily, particularly in young universities where indigenous senior faculty is not yet available.

5. Honorarium/Remuneration:

5.1. Professor Emeritus shall be entitled for financial benefits for a maximum period of 10 years or up to the age of 70 years whichever is earlier and draw a consolidated amount of honorarium of Rs. 200,000/p.m. (all inclusive) with an annual increase of 5%.

5.2. The concerned parent university will bear financial liability of Professor Emeritus out of its own resources for both categories of PE i.e. Professors/Vice Chancellors. However, HEC will bear remunerations of **only** those category of Vice Chancellors who offer their services as Professor Emeritus in newly developed universities, other than their parent university (reference Section 2).

5.3. The initial offer of appointment will be for a period of 5 years, extendable on a yearly basis for the purpose of financial benefits.

5.4. The conferment of Emeritus Status shall normally be for lifetime but can be terminated if the Professor so desired or the Syndicate terminates by ¾ majority on grounds of inefficiency, moral turpitude or physical or mental incapacity or gross misconduct.

5.5. During the paid tenure of Professor Emeritus, he/she will not get financial benefits from any other university/institution/organization. In case, PE gets appointed on any other full time position during the paid tenure, within or outside parent university, the payment for PE will be discontinued for that period.

Similarly, those Vice Chancellors who join as Professor Emeritus at a newly developed university, other than the parent university, will also not be paid the honorarium of PE if he/she is employed with any other university/institution/organization, or employed by the host university on another position within the paid tenure of Professor Emeritus.